

Theatre, Puppetry and Performance Traditions - Continuous At-a-Glance Flowchart

Natya Shastra -> Sanskrit stage -> Kutiyattam -> folk theatre -> modern stage -> puppetry -> safeguarding

Follow the cyan rail from dramaturgy to living-safeguarding logic; the grey E node is optional caution, not core coverage.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Review status: repaired Topic 10 flowchart regenerated for user review; all prior artifacts unchanged.

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 Natya Shastra theatre grammar

NATYA VEDA BHARATA LOKADHARMI NATYADHARMI COMPOSITE ART

text enactment music rasa

SAFE CORE

- Indian theatre begins as composite performance grammar, not as script alone.

MODE

- Lokadharmi = realistic depiction; Natyadharmi = stylised symbolic narration.

DATE CONTROL

- Use a broad late-BCE / early-CE horizon for the layered Natya Shastra tradition.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The highest-scoring opening in this topic defines theatre through grammar before listing any regional form.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian theatre should begin with Natya Shastra because the tradition defines performance as text, enactment, music and rasa in one composed system.

01

STAGE 01 Classical stage, convention and decline

TEN RUPAKAS SUTRADHAR VIDUSAKA STAGE RULES DECLINE CAUSES

VOCABULARY

- Rupaka list, Sutradhar threshold, Nayaka-Nayika-Vidusaka triad and Prakrit register clue.

CONVENTION

- Multi-act structure, rare tragedy, curtains and two-level stage appear as recorded rules, not universal census facts.

DECLINE

- Writers moved to poems and songs; difficult Sanskrit lost reach; patronage changed.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Codified rules explain the classical stage more safely than plot summary or civilisational cliché.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The safest way to explain Sanskrit theatre is through its recorded conventions and decline mechanisms, while refusing to turn prescription or disputed archaeology into universal fact.

02

STAGE 02 Kutiyattam as living continuity

KERALA NIRVAHANA MIZHAVU UNESCO 2008 LIVING LINEAGE

IDENTITY

- Kutiyattam is the living Sanskrit-theatre bridge in Kerala.

FORM

- Multilingual performance, Nirvahana opening logic and Mizhavu-Edakka sound-world identify it quickly.

OFFICIAL

- UNESCO calls it one of India's oldest living theatrical traditions and records a 2008 Representative-List inscription.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Kutiyattam proves survival of a lineage without erasing the larger historical contraction of Sanskrit theatre.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kutiyattam matters because it prevents the lazy statement that Sanskrit theatre died; it shows a living continuity embedded in Kerala's regional institutions.

03

STAGE 03 Folk theatre publics and regional forms

DEVOTIONAL ARC JATRA NAUTANKI TAMASHA BHAVAI REGION-CLUE

ARC

- Many folk theatres move from devotional beginnings to heroic/romantic repertoire and later social messaging.

REGIONAL BANK

- Yakshagana, Jatra, Nautanki, Tamasha, Bhavai, Bhaona, Therukoothu, Bhand Pather and Dashavatar must be identified by one clean marker each.

CAUTION

- Do not project present state labels backwards as fixed ancient borders or treat all folk theatre as unchanged residue.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Regional theatre scores only when the answer links form to audience, theme and one discriminating stage clue.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Folk theatre is best written as a changing public medium rooted in locality, then widened through devotional, heroic and social-message performance.

DEVOTIONAL ARC

JATRA

NAUTANKI

TAMASHA

BHAVAI

REGION-CLUE

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MECHANISM / VERDICT

Regional theatre scores only when the answer links form to audience, theme and one discriminating stage clue.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Folk theatre is best written as a changing public medium rooted in locality, then widened through devotional, heroic and social-message performance.

04

STAGE 04

Colonial-modern stage and institutions

1775

1876 ACT

PARSI

IPTA 1943

PRITHVI 1944

THIRD THEATRE

URBAN HYBRID

• Modern theatre grew in colonial cities through proscenium form, commerce and Indian-Western interaction.

POLITICAL PUBLIC

• Dramatic Performances Act, IPTA and Prithvi show theatre as regulated, mobile and socially interventionist.

POST-1947

• SNA, NSD, NINASAM, Kalakshetra Manipur and Third Theatre widen the institutional map.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Modern theatre is a history of publics and institutions, not a single westernisation story.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Modern Indian theatre should be written as a colonial-city hybrid that reworked Indian themes through proscenium stages, regulation, touring publics and later institutions.

05

STAGE 05

Puppetry by mechanism and region

STRING

SHADOW

ROD

GLOVE

KATHPUTLI

THOLU

CLASSIFY FIRST

• String, shadow, rod and glove are control systems before they are regional traditions.

REGIONAL MARKERS

• Kathputli, Kundhei, Gombeyatta, Tolpava Kuthu, Ravana Chhaya, Tholu Bommalata, Yampuri, Putul Nach and Pavakoothu are the key route markers.

ARCHIVE VALUE

• Epic references, the Sutradhar link and the puppeteer metaphor let puppetry be read as transmission as well as entertainment.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

Puppetry questions are usually solved by mechanism first and repertoire or ritual context second.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Indian puppetry scores only when mechanism comes first: string, shadow, rod and glove are control systems before they are regional examples.

06

STAGE 06

Safeguarding, martial links and final answer route

KALARIPAYATTU

ONGOING VULNERABILITY

LIVELIHOOD

BOUNDARY

ANSWER ROUTE

identify

→

compare

→

qualify

→

conclude

TWO DECLINE TYPES

• Sanskrit theatre's contraction is historical; puppetry's audience-funding crisis is ongoing and living.

MIXED ECOLOGY

• Ritual, devotional, martial and satirical publics coexist; Kalaripayattu, Thang-ta and Gatka are not generic dance labels.

BOUNDARY

• Topic 10 owns enacted dramaturgy and stage ecology, not the full technical histories of music, dance, literature or UNESCO ledgers.

MECHANISM / VERDICT

The highest-scoring conclusion distinguishes completed contraction from living vulnerability and then states what kind of safeguarding each requires.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE

WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The most mature answer in this topic distinguishes a completed historical contraction of Sanskrit theatre from the ongoing vulnerability of puppetry and living performance traditions.

E

EXTRA

Optional caution: overclaim control

SITABENGA

STATE BOUNDARIES

PLAYWRIGHT GAP

NO GUESSWORK

DISPUTE

• The 'world's oldest amphitheatre' label for Sitabenga-Jogimara must remain qualified.

GEOGRAPHY

• Modern state labels are locators; they are not retrospective proof of unchanged premodern political geography.

RESTRAINT

• Do not invent a Sanskrit playwright catalogue or objective answer letter where the verified bank did not independently establish it.

OPTIONAL STATUS

This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; advanced maturity means stating the evidentiary limit instead of guessing.